

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Annual Developer Survey

65,437 respondents • 180+ countries • 2024

Key findings on employment patterns, salary by role and language, and workplace preferences to inform hiring and retention strategies.

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Employment status breakdown — global versus U.S. trends

69%

Full-Time Employment
(Global)

16.4%

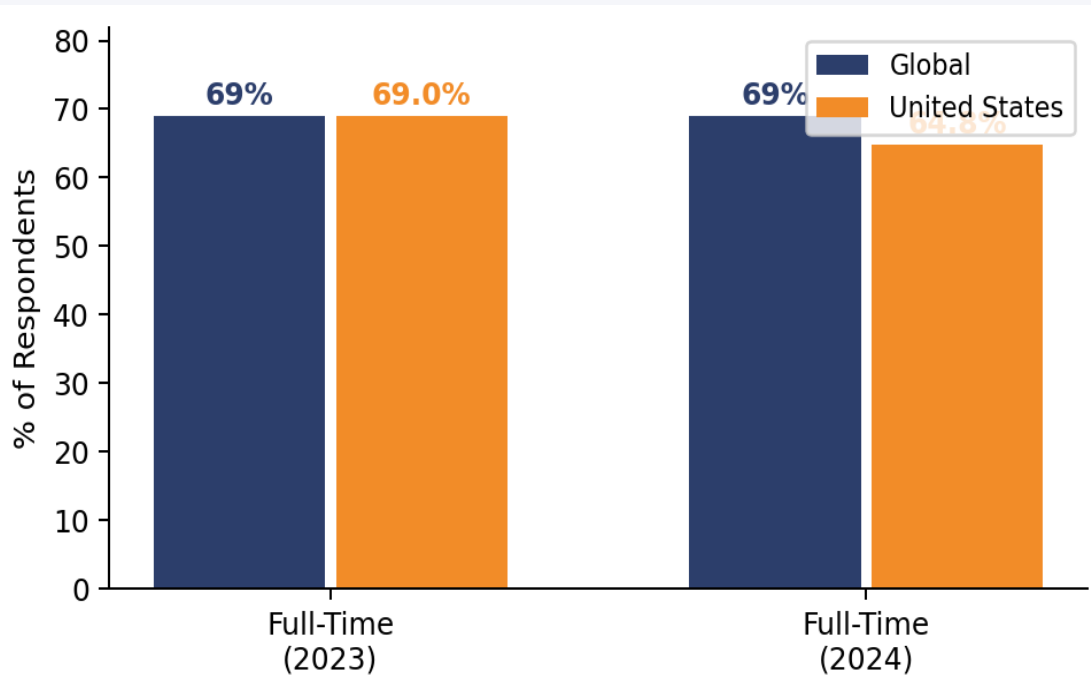
Freelance /
Contract

13.2%

Full-Time
Students

84%

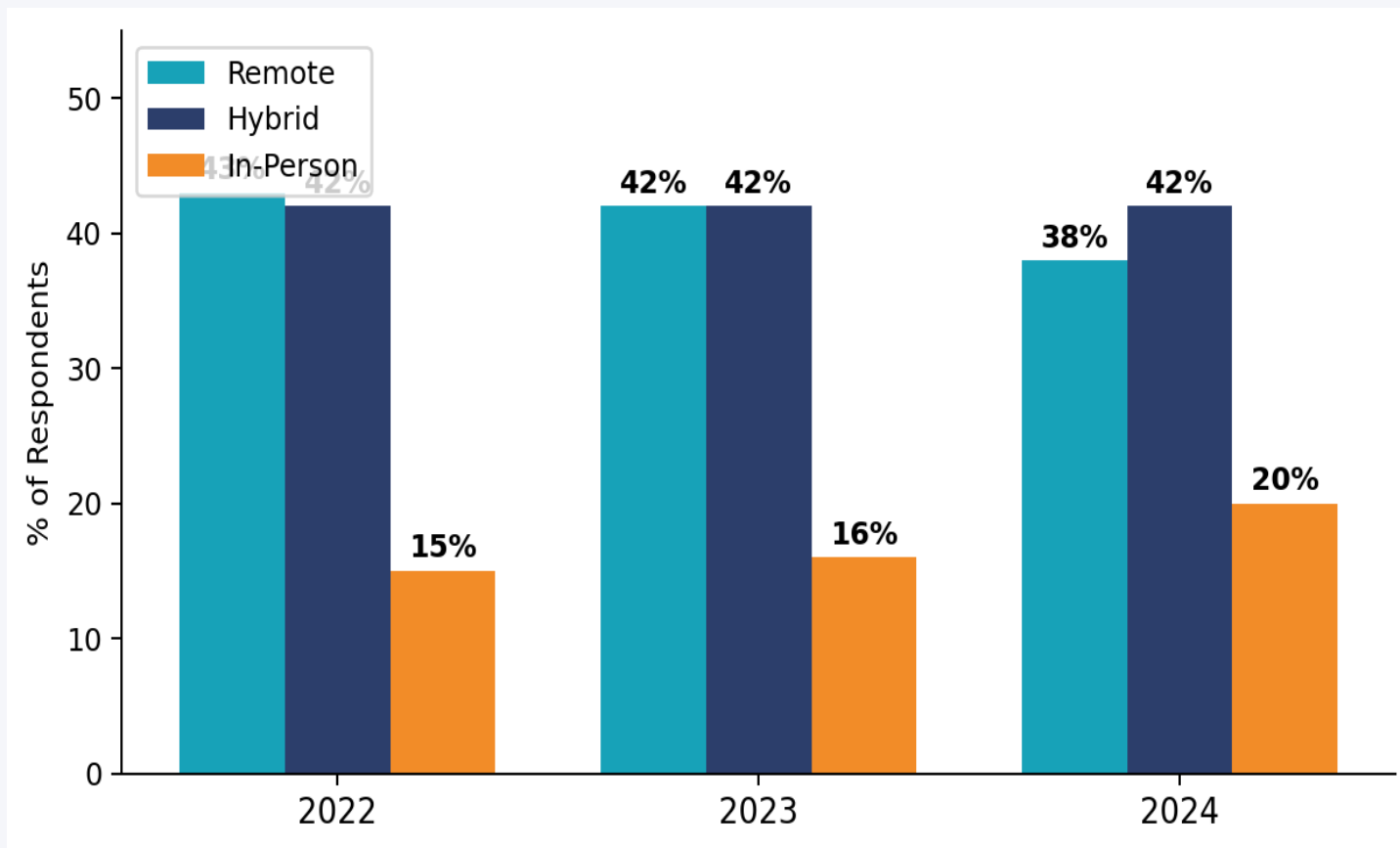
Currently
Working



- U.S. full-time employment fell 4 pp YoY (69% → 64.8%)
- Freelancing/contracting remains significant at 16.4% globally
- U.K. and Ukraine lean toward independent contracting
- Germany and India see more full-time students among non-FT respondents

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

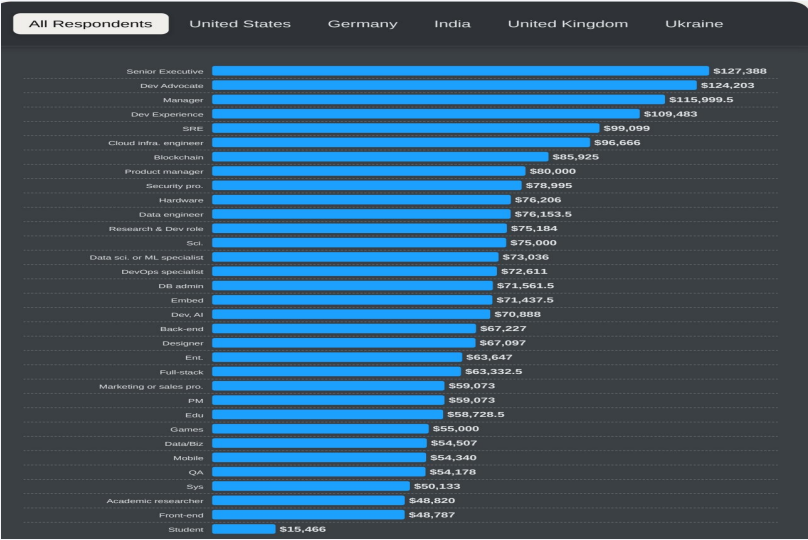
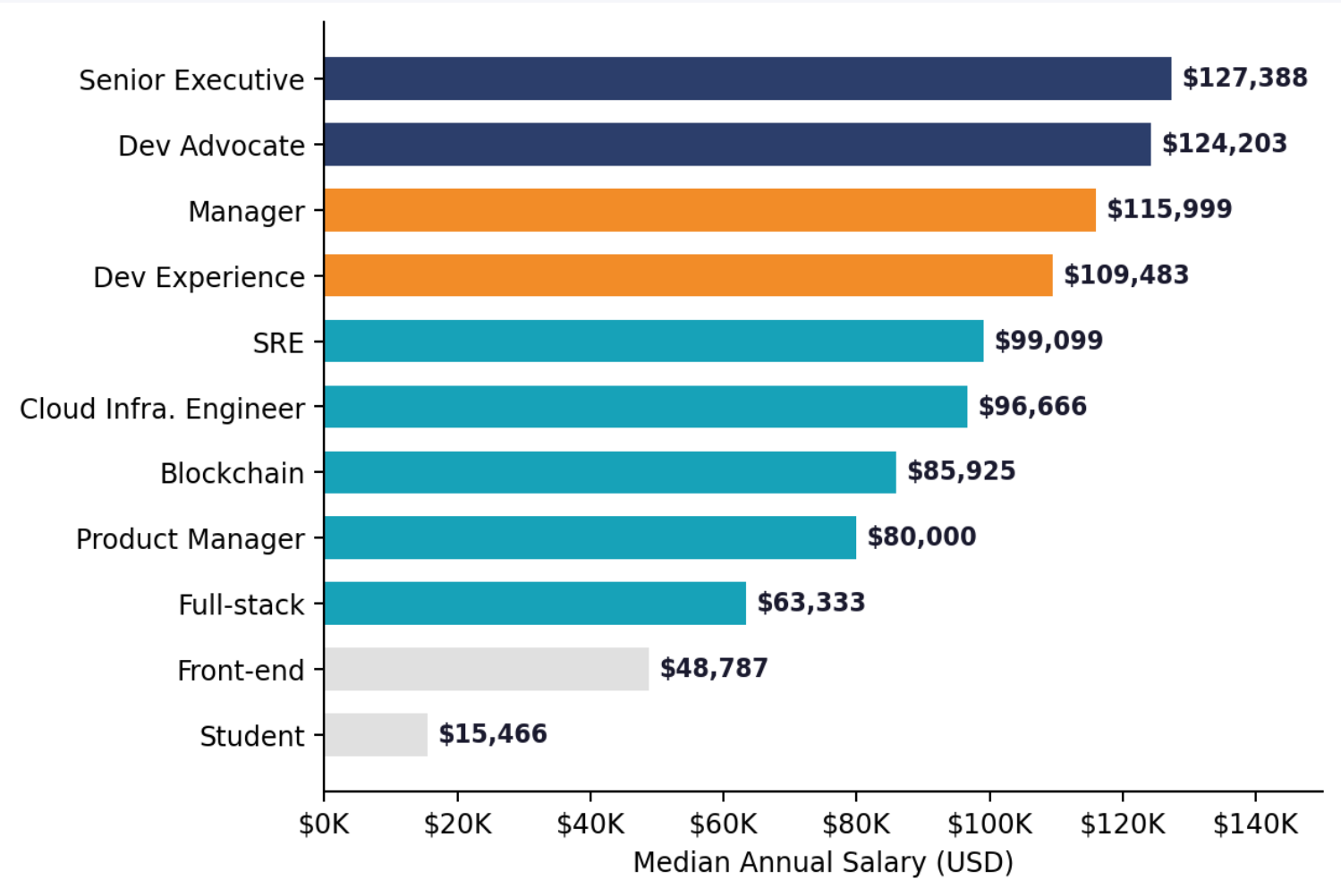
Three-year trend in work environment preferences (2022–2024)



- Hybrid remains dominant at 42% for two consecutive years
- In-person work rose from 15% (2022) to 20% (2024) — a 5 pp increase over 3 years
- Remote work down ~5 pp, signaling a gradual return-to-office trend
- Implication: office-based perks and co-location strategies are gaining relevance for retention

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

Median annual compensation (USD) by developer type — 22,677 salary responses

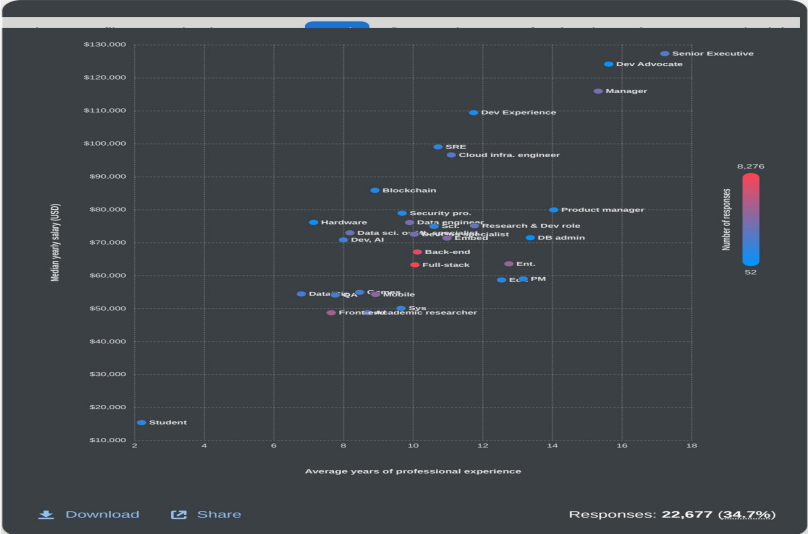
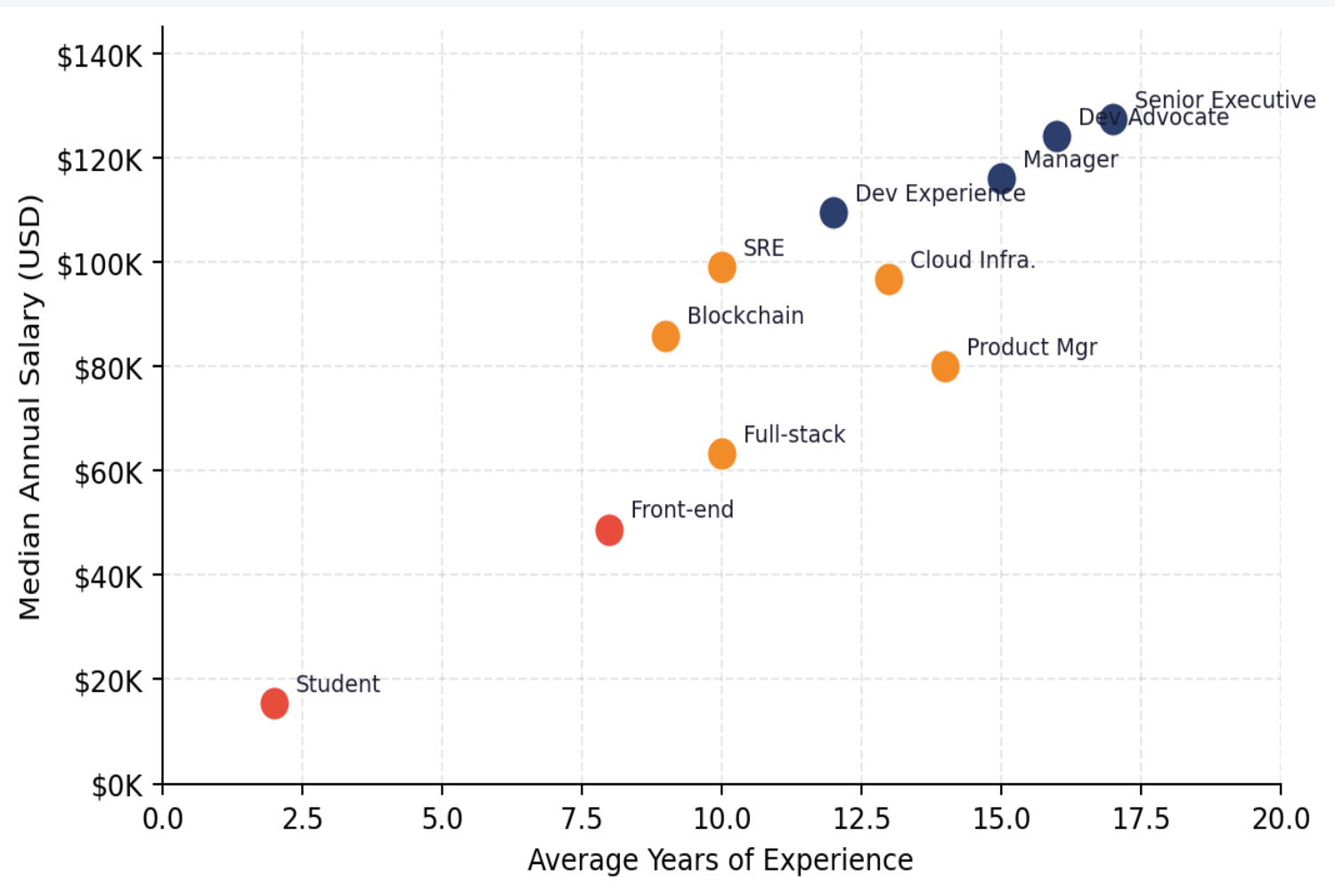


Reference: figure_1.jpg

- SRE and Cloud Infra are the highest-paid purely technical roles
- Leadership + DevRel roles all require 15+ years avg. experience
- Regional variation: mobile devs earn more in U.S.; data engineers top charts in Germany & Ukraine

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Scatter: median salary vs. average years of experience by developer type

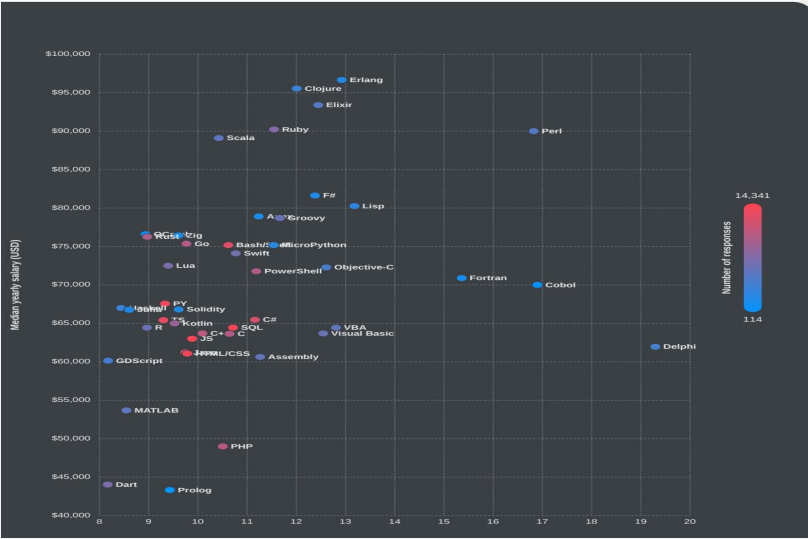
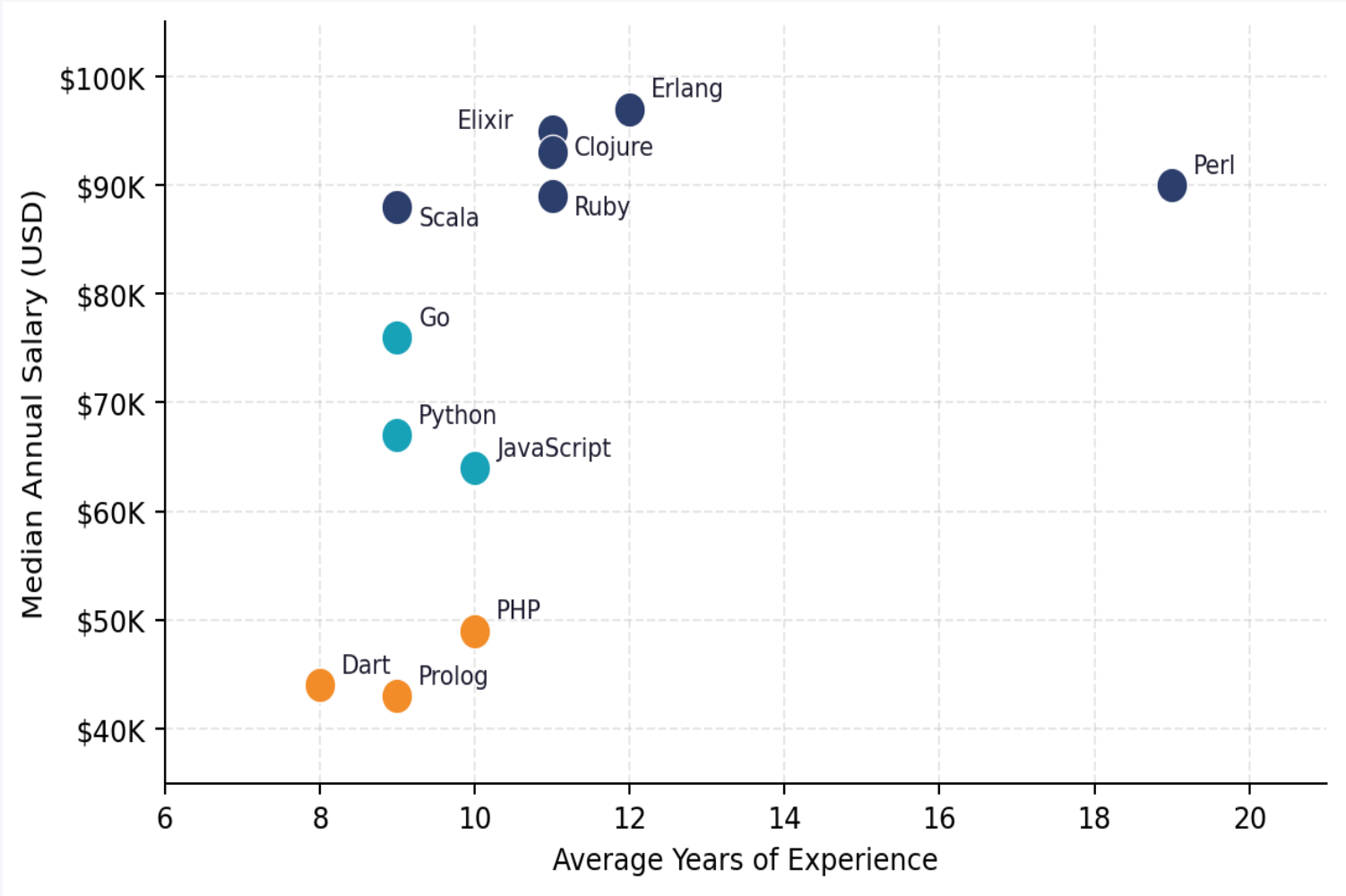


Reference: figure_2.jpg

- Senior roles cluster in the upper-right (high exp + high pay)
- Student is the clear outlier at ~\$15K with ~2 years experience
- Product Manager: high experience (14 yrs) but lower relative pay (\$80K)

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. experience by programming language — note ~\$10K drop vs. 2023

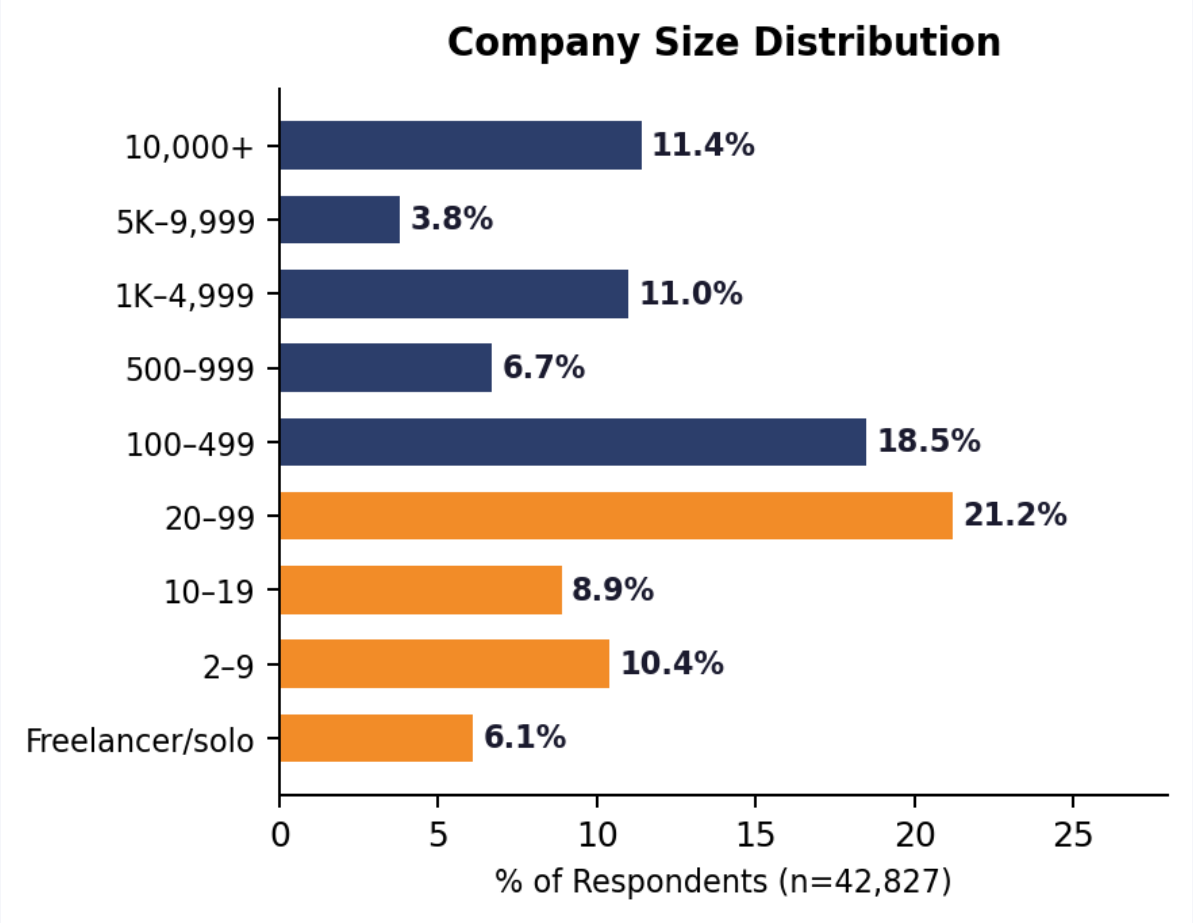


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- Niche functional languages (Erlang, Clojure, Elixir) command \$93K+ median
- Perl is an outlier: highest experience (19 yrs) but \$90K — seniority, not demand
- Overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (\$60–75K avg. vs. \$70–85K)
- Mainstream languages (JS, PHP) sit well below \$65K

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company size distribution and developer purchasing influence



47% of developers work at organizations with <100 employees

Technology Purchasing Influence

62%

Have Purchase Influence

60%

Prefer Build-and-Buy

- Senior Executives: 99% influence purchases
- Engineering Managers: 87% influence purchases
- Product Managers: 77% influence purchases
- Top eval methods: free trial (75%), asking devs (73%)
- Vendor implication: target ICs, not just management

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1

Full-time employment is softening

U.S. FT employment fell 4 pp YoY. Plan for a growing share of contractors and freelancers in your workforce mix.

2

In-person mandates are growing, but hybrid dominates

In-person rose to 20%, yet 42% remain hybrid. Office-based perks and flexible policies are key retention levers.

3

DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay

Dev Advocates (\$124K) and SREs (\$99K) are among the highest-paid technical roles. Budget accordingly for these critical hires.

4

Language choice correlates with compensation

Niche functional languages (Erlang, Clojure, Elixir) pay >\$93K median. Mainstream languages (JS, PHP) sit below \$65K. Factor language stack into comp benchmarking.

5

Developers are key purchase influencers

62% have a say in tech buying decisions. Vendor and tool strategies should engage individual contributors directly, not just management.